DATA MINIMISATION CHECKLIST

Data Minimisation Checklist

Project: Privacy & Data Protection Internship
Use: Student-facing services and research projects

A. Purpose and Collection

- A clear purpose for collecting the data has been documented.
- Every requested field has a specific reason.
- Unnecessary fields have been removed.
- Anonymous data or participant codes have been considered.
- Sensitive information is collected only when justified and appropriately authorised.
- The team has checked whether the purpose can be achieved with less personal data.

B. Privacy Notice and Consent

- People are informed about what information is collected and why.
- The intended use of the information is explained in simple language.
- Optional and required fields are clearly identified.
- The applicable legal basis has been identified.
- Consent is obtained and recorded where appropriate.
- Participants are told about relevant sharing, retention and privacy contact arrangements.

C. Access Control and Storage

- Data is stored in an approved, secure location.
- Access is limited to authorised people.
- Individual accounts and appropriate authentication are used.

- Public sharing links are avoided for confidential information.
- Personal information is not uploaded to public repositories.
- Access permissions are reviewed when responsibilities change.

D. Retention and Review

- A retention period or review date has been defined.
- Legal, ethical and institutional retention requirements have been checked.
- Contact information is separated from research responses where practical.
- Duplicate files and unnecessary exports are reviewed.
- Information is not retained indefinitely without justification.

E. Safe Deletion

- Information that is no longer required has been identified.
- Approved secure-deletion procedures are followed.
- Paper records are securely shredded or disposed of.
- Relevant copies and backups are handled according to policy.
- Deletion is documented where required.

F. Final Review

- The collection process has been reviewed for unnecessary data.
- A responsible person has been assigned to manage the records.
- Any identified privacy risks have been addressed or escalated.
- The checklist has been reviewed and approved by the responsible team member.

Project name: _____

Reviewer: _____

Review date: _____

Issues requiring action:

Important: This checklist supports good practice. It does not replace applicable law, institutional policies, research ethics approval or professional advice.